terest of the Dominions. Its possible influence on British relationships both with the Far East and with the United States of America must also be regarded as of special moment. Finally, within the ranks of the Government's supporters, there has developed a serious disagreement which goes to the root of present British policy in India. The immediate political effect of the presentation of the forthcoming report will probably, give more anxiety to Mr. Baldwin as leader of the Conservatives than as Lord President of the Council. There is no need to recapitulate the point of cleavage, in detailed fashion. It is sufficient to say that Mr. Winston Churchill has supported a right-wing Conservative movement which, in defiance of the weighty opinions of the men on the spot and of the responsible members of the Cabinet, seeks to traverse the fundamental position taken up by the Government in the White Paper. There are signs that an important section of the malcontents, including possibly Mr. Churchill himself, may be appeased by the findings of the Joint Select Committee before which Mr. Churchill made an effective appearance. There is, however, another and less placable section headed by Sir Henry Page Croft. It may be trusted to resist the Bill to the bitter end. Whether it eventually will be found to command more than fifty votes in the House of Commons remains to be seen.

The agitation against the White Paper—contemptuously called by Lord Rothermere the "White Flag" —proposals has been fierce and by no means scrupulous. During the past summer an outrageous attempt to exploit the late Jam Sahib's popularity with the British public, as "Ranji," ventured to regale the country with a "sob" story of that ruler's death. It was blatantly suggested, in spite of prosaic evidence to the contrary, that "Ranji" had died of a broken heart because of Lord Willingdon's obstinacy in supporting the Government's policy. Mr. Churchill, in a waspish desire to "trip up Sam," as Mr. Amery deftly put it, allowed himself to display to the Manchester Chamber of Commerce a pathetic ignorance of the significance of the convention long assuring fiscal autonomy to India. The Government has been hampered by its own sense of fidelity to pledges. It undertook that during the sittings of the Joint Committee, no Cabinet Minister would discuss publicly the proposals *sub judice*. To this undertaking it has adhered in spite of great provocation which has included the stampeding of the country houses and clubs—and through them local Conservative Associations—into a raging, tearing campaign against the "surrender in India." These repudiators of the policy of trusting the men on the spot, on which they used to lay such emphasis when they were in harness as Empire builders, have received a marked check from two distinct sources. The formation of the Union of Britain and India, composed (with trifling exceptions) of all the most distinguished retired senior officials with recent experience of India, has, patiently and by reasoned citation of facts, corrected the frothy emotion of Sir Henry Page Croft's troglodytes. During the last few months, the presence in England of soldiers and civilians temporarily on leave from India has reassured a number of sensible folk who were puzzled by the Government's self-imposed silence and dismayed by the jeremiads of its ostensible supporters and critics. When the Joint Report is published Mr. Baldwin, Sir Samuel Hoare and Lord Halifax will be free to devote themselves to the complete education of their party. They are well aware that their domestic difficulty is matched in India by Lord Willingdon's preoccupations in the diametrically opposite sense. He has to convince moderate Indian opinion that the Government's proposals give India the substance on which the structure of a Dominion of India can be built. He has to fortify that opinion against the Congress extremists who loudly claim that the White Paper is a sham. Though Mr. Neville Chamberlain, the other day, was technically correct in insisting on the supreme authority of Parliament, it has to be borne in mind that the good faith of Great Britain behind that Parliament is concerned in the maintenance of the general trend of the White Paper as embodying decisions reached in agreement with accredited Indian representatives. That, briefly, is the picture of the contending parties involved in this Indian drama. Extremists in the two countries appear fortunately to be in the minority. It is no bad thing that criticism from both camps is vocal, but it is greatly to be hoped that, when the Government has definitely placed its Bill before Parliament, the passage to the statute book, albeit marked by the usual vigorous debates, will be assured in the course of the coming year. Nothing would be more unsatisfactory, both to England and India, than for a General Election in Great Britain to be fought on the Indian issue. The legislation itself is highly technical. So long as broad principles are settled, the attendant controversy should do no more than produce, between the raging extremes, a sane solution leading to a workmanlike scheme.

THE WAY OF THE WORLD

IMPORTANT CASE

Considerable importance will attach to the decision of the U.S. Supreme Court, which, according to a telegram published elsewhere in this issue, is to be called upon and decide upon the constitutionality of Congress's decision to abrogate the "gold clause" in contracts. The matter has been decided in a lower court in favour of the Government, and it is now taken before the highest court in the land for the purpose of settling the question once and for all. In the lower court the Judge held that the "gold clause" was a promise to pay in gold, not as money, but as a mere commodity, reducing the whole transaction, therefore, to one of barter. Action by Congress has made payment in the form stipulated in the contracts impossible, and the Judge was called upon to decide whether the proffer of legal tender as it is now established constituted proper payment. In finding that it did, the Judge made an effective point that no person in the United States had the right to make a contract the effect of which was to nullify, obstruct or circumvent the power of Congress to say what shall be the national money or medium of exchange. While the Supreme Court will ultimately have to find whether the judge's finding is correct or not, it certainly presents a consideration which may come as a surprise to most people. If it is upheld it means that contracts requiring a payment by one side or the other can only mean that such payment shall be made in the currency of the country, whatever it happens to be for the time being. To a degree this might have an unsettling effect upon business, especially in connection with long term contracts, for the party to whom payment is to be paid need not necessarily know in what form he would receive his money. If the ruling is upheld it will mean the commodity definitions in contracts involving payment will go by the board. If it is rejected, then large payments in currency will be required to represent the gold value stipulated.

THE MORRO CASTLE

In view of the press despatches in connection with the fire on board the ss. Morro Castle, it is difficult to see what other findings could have been arrived at by the investigation board of the United States Steamboat Inspection Service than those which appear in another column. The findings concern the conduct of the officers and the crew, and there is reason to believe that the condemnation therein expressed is correct, though with regard to the acting captain the gravamen of his fault seems to consist rather of an error in judgment than dereliction of duty. Of his immediate subordinates who are also in danger of losing their certificates it may be said that they failed to maintain that degree of discipline so imperatively necessary in times of disaster. It is easy enough to dogmatize on what should be the conduct of a crew in such a case as that of this unfortunate ship, but humanity does break under the strain at times. The lesson to be sought in such disasters as these of the Georges Phillippar, the Atlantique and the Morro Castle, however, more nearly concern ship construction, than the conduct of men in such appalling conditions as were found of each of those vessels. It has been made tragically apparent that there is the greatest possible necessity for a considerable modification in the building of such ships with a view, firstly, to prevent the outbreak of fire, and, secondly, to prevent the rapid spread of the flames which has been apparent in each case under notice. If these disasters have proved anything at all it is that present methods of construction are totally unsuited for ships in which large numbers of persons are habitually carried. To a very great extent this has been due to competition in luxuriousness which has led to the employment of materials wholly unfitted for the purpose on board ship, and if the expected reforms tend towards the establishment of a greater degree of simplicity both traveller and shipping company should benefit thereby.

A FAMOUS FULL BACK

The glorious days of amateur soccer are recalled by the news of the death in a motoring accident last month of Mr. William John Oakley—affectionately known as "Oakers" to colleagues and pupils alike. W. J. Oakley with C. B. Fry formed the classic full-back combination of the days when G. O. Smith was England's centre-forward. The three were in a famous Oxford team together and Oakley gained 16 international caps. With G. O. Smith (whom he also partnered as a schoolmaster in charge of the Ludgrove School originally started by Arthur Dunn) he was joint author of the volume on Association Football in the Badminton Library. A fine all-round athlete, Oakley won the 120 hurdles against Cambridge was second string, with 22½ feet, to C. B. Fry in the long jump and was in the Oxford Trial Eights of 1894. He won the amateur long jump championship in the same year. C. B. Fry who partnered him for several years in the Corinthian eleven, has described him as the best amateur back England ever possessed, after the brothers Walters. Mr. Fry has added

> "He had great pace, was a strong and sure tackler and kicked accurately and powerfully to his forwards. No professional forward of his time could outpace him. Most of them he smothered."

Oakley was an Old Salopian and at Christ Church, Oxford, he took honours in mathematical moderations and in the final school of natural science. He was an altogether delightful personality. His fine physique, quiet good humour and essential humanity gave him at extraordinary ascendancy over his pupils.

WINTER IN U.S.

A telegram indicating the amount of relief which the United States Government will be called upon to provide during the coming winter, gives some idea of the magnitude of the problem with which the government is confronted. It is expected by Mr. Donald R. Richberg, in his report to the President, that no fewer than 23,000,000 men, women and children will have to be cared for during the winter at a cost of approximately $170,000,000 a month. On the face of it, it would seem that the new deal has failed to give that relief which is claimed for it, but in another report on the president's policy it was pointed out that over 4,000,000 persons had been re-employed since the new deal was commenced. The report consequently serves more to indicate the immensity of President's Roosevelt's original task than to detract from the full significance of the improvements that have already been effected. Be that as it may, the existence of so large a number of persons without adequate subsistence especially in a country where the winters are necessarily severe, must give the authorities much cause for anxiety, for destitution and the desperation resulting therefrom are the biggest factors tending towards lawlessness which during the coming cold weather is to be greatly feared. The state of affairs has been by no means improved by the drought which prevailed during the summer. If critics of the administration seize upon this latest report as evidence of the failure of the president's policy, they may to some extent be justified, but what might have happened had Mr. Roosevelt not taken such energetic measures as he did when he assumed office, has also to be taken into account, and then it becomes clear that if he has not yet succeeded in demonstrably improving matters, he at least has undoubtedly succeeded in preventing them from becoming worse.

SHANGHAI NOTES

"AUTUMN CROCUS"

An esteemed correspondent once again shows that in the theatre, as elsewhere, there can always be more than one opinion. In so far as he agrees with this journal in praising the acting of the clever cast who are presenting Miss Anthony's comedy at the Lyceum Theatre this week, there is no need to add anything to the review published yesterday. The issue is thus narrowed down to the worthiness of the comedy chosen by the Committee of the A.D.C.—a body of Shanghailanders who, it is not indiscreet to affirm, give most careful thought to all plays suggested to them for production. "Autumn Crocus" brought instant fame and name to its author, whose first play it was and who was no professional writer but a woman engaged in arduous and responsible work in a big London departmental store. It ran with great success in London and, now that its merits have been assailed, it may be useful to recall the reception accorded to it on production at the Lyric Theatre, London, on April 6, 1931. It suffered a little from the unfortunate mishandling of the "noises off" in one of the scenes. This led to minor but irritating gallery interruptions to which the conscientious critic of 'The Times' felt bound to refer. When it came to assessing the play, the critic observed

> It is a tale that Turgenlev would not have been unwilling to tell, and there is in "Autumn Crocus" a hint of that enchantment which falls upon a reader of the "Torrents of Spring"—a hint at least strong enough to show in what country Miss Anthony's ambition moves. She does not carry Turgenlev's wand: her magic is thinner and she dwells in sentiment when he would have transcended sentiment in poetry, establishing ecstasy by some swift miracle of restraint. Of this she is incapable, but there is a dew upon her love scenes which is a genuine refreshment of the theatre and her drawing of the detail of subordinate character is observant and amusing. She makes too much of her detail and too much of her humour, pleasant though they both are—too much, that is to say, if her chief purpose is to make of her love story a composed work of art....

And he concluded by prophesying success for the play—a prophecy richly fulfilled. This journal's dramatic critic wrote his review without knowledge of the "The Times's" opinion but it will be noted that, on both of them, the play made the same impression of fragrance and happily handled comedy. This does not necessarily dispose of the weighty arguments now brought forward to condemn the play but it certainly shows that it can be acted and enjoyed without any irksome detection of sordid motives. Perhaps "First Nighter" might find it profitable to read the play as published by Gollancz in order to get a surer idea of its intentions. For example, his dislike of the characters Audrey and Alaric seems to overlook the author's evident purpose of ridiculing a modern cult by making its devotees condemn themselves out of their own absurdly youthful mouths. Therein the play renders a sound moral service, albeit in lightly gentle vein.

R.A.S. JOURNAL

The sixty-fifth issue of the Journal of the North China Branch of the Royal Asiatic Society has now been published and it is, as usual, an annual of considerable interest to people in China and others abroad who interest themselves in Chinese affairs. A review of the volume is hardly necessary because the bulk of the contributions have really seen the light of day in the form of papers read before the Society. Dr. E. M. Gale, the Editor, is represented among the contributors by translations of Yen T'ieh Lun's Discourses on Salt and Iron, Dr. J. C. Ferguson's address on the reopening of the Shanghai Museum, and Mr. A. de. C. Sowerby's on the History of the Shanghai Museum are given pride of place and, therefore, put on record a notable event in the career of the Society. Dr. Ferguson also contributes a paper on Painters among Catholic Missionaries and their Helpers in Peking with interesting illustrations; and Dr. Chatley's learned examination of the Cycles of Cathay is another contribution which it is pleasant to have in accessible form. Mr. Teng Kuei expounds the mysteries of bamboo painting, and Mr. D. W. Lyon reviews the past decade in Chinese literature. Many other items of interest are also included in the journal and it contains, incidentally, an authoritative list of the members of the Society. The present membership amounts to 722, a net increase of twenty-seven on the previous year. The evidence that the Royal Asiatic Society in Shanghai is vigorously progressing in its new premises is, therefore, cheeringly convincing.

THE GOLF CHAMPION

Mr. J. B. Broadus of the Fourth Marines added to the already distinguished sporting record of that famous American unit in Shanghai by winning the amateur Golf Championship of China on Saturday. Mr. Broadus was a competitor last year and he thus becomes Champion at the second time of asking. He broke a record and, incidentally, defeated a doughty and brilliant golfer in Mr. F. D. Hunter who was a "champion" runner up. Finding his Saturday morning's record of 69 for the Seekingjao course beaten by Mr. Broadus with 67 in the afternoon, Mr. Hunter proceeded on Sunday morning to set up another record of 71 for the Hungjao course. This bare recital indicates the standard of golf required to give the winner his championship. His Corps will no doubt have welcomed their latest trophy with appropriate enthusiasm. They can be assured that all golfers in Shanghai—including the sporting visitors from Hongkong—are highly delighted at the victory.

LEARNING CHINESE

The commencement of the autumn term of the Chinese Language School of the British Chamber of Commerce affords an opportunity not only of drawing attention to the good work which the school has done since its inception, but also to the necessity for the young man of to-day to acquire a good working knowledge of the language. The days when a man could come to China and expect to transact all his business through a compradore are fast disappearing, and there is a growing need for the closest possible understanding between the foreign and Chinese trader, which can only be achieved by ability to talk to each other whether in the English or Chinese languages. In this respect it is true that the spread of English amongst the Chinese might be held to obviate the necessity of the study of Chinese by foreigners, but it will be remembered that on occasion the Nanking Government has announced its intention of enforcing the use of the Chinese language in all official written communications, while those whose business takes them into the interior will find a knowledge of the language almost a prime essential. The method by which Chinese is taught in the Language school, under a foreign principal with individual tuition and modern textbooks ensures that the study will be made with the least possible difficulty. A number of employers already realize the importance of their employees learning the language, and undoubtedly assist them in doing so.

A NEW EWO COASTER

Good news with an importance of its own comes in the in the disclosure that Messrs. Jardine, Matheson and Company have placed an order with a Glasgow yard for a new coaster. Apart from the fact that thereby work is being given to a British yard for seven months, the enterprise of the great Shanghai firm in these dull days gives a tonic note of cheering intensity. At a time when the internal trade of China is being dolefully canvassed, a practical sign of confidence in the future is surely welcomed. Shanghai, like other parts of China, is not specially happy about the days immediately ahead. The world depression has reached this port with some display of assertiveness. Shanghai is not wont to play the laggard even in adversity and, as a straw shows the wind's direction, so the modest portent at Glasgow may be taken to exemplify the traditional courage with which Shanghai, during its honourable career has faced the ups and downs of commerce in the Far East.

TWENTY YEARS

Congratulations are due to the Shanghai Scottish on the attainment of the twentieth year of its existence. The reception which the President of the St. Andrew's Society and Mrs. Ranald McDonald are giving in honour of the Company, according to yearly custom, will, therefore, be taken specially to set up a milestone in the unit's career. The Shanghai Scottish have played in the S.V.C. a part on which it is unnecessary to dwell in detail. Are not the files of this journal eloquent thereon? Those who are keen on the progress of the Corps as a whole will welcome the honour which the National Society does to the Scottish Company as a sign of strong approval of the movement for bringing the Settlement's defenders up to strength.

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